Start vimdiff with temporary files/buffers
Either
- start vimdiff with temporary files, or
- create temporary buffers from inside vim

Method 1: open vimdiff with temporary files

```
vimdiff /tmp/left /tmp/right           # /tmp/left and /tmp/right
don't need to exist
```

Method 2: create temporary buffers in vim

```
" Create left buffer
:badd /tmp/left
:buffer /tmp/left
:diffthis               " Set diff

" Create right buffer
:vsplit
:badd /tmp/right
:buffer /tmp/left
:diffthis               " Set diff
```

Use vimdiff on an existing/open file
Just set :diffthis

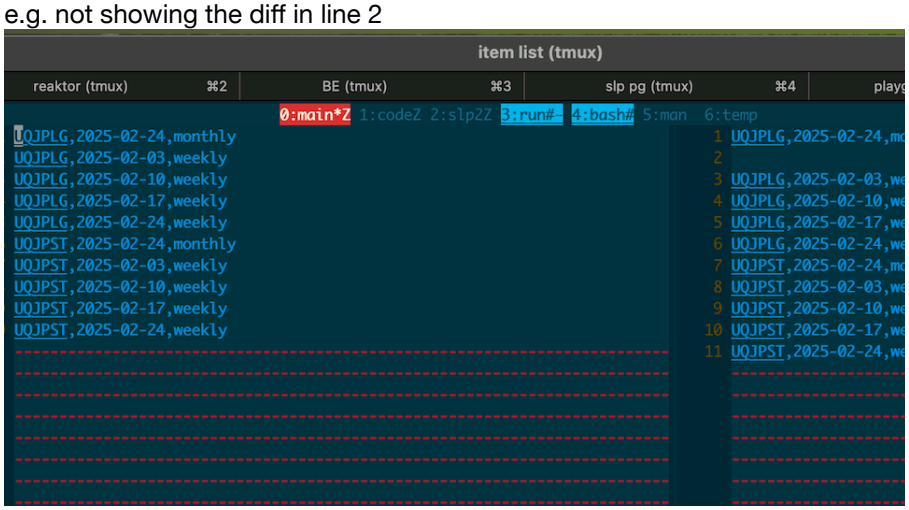
```
" Open file
:vsplit
:edit myfile.txt

" Clear existing diffs, if any.
" Otherwise, it may not work correctly.
:diffoff!

" Add to diff
:diffthis
" Remove from diff
:diffthis
```

[Troubleshooting] diffthis does not show diff as expected

e.g. not showing the diff in line 2



after fix



Problem: there are other buffers being diffed
Solution: turn off diffs

```
" Reset diffs
:diffoff!

" Re-add to diff
:diffthis
```

Check if diff mode
Use the diff variable

```
:diffthis
:echo &diff          1
:diffremove
:echo &diff          0
```

Detect if diff mode

```
if &diff
     # diff mode setup
else
     # otherwise
endif
```